

Capstone Design Manager

Project Documentation

User Guide - Capstone Design Manager

A comprehensive guide for all users of the Capstone Design Manager application, including Students, Sponsors, and Administrators.

Table of Contents

1. [Overview](#)
2. [Getting Started](#)
3. [Student Guide](#)
4. [Sponsor Guide](#)
5. [Admin Guide](#)
6. [Email System](#)
7. [Troubleshooting](#)

1. Overview

The Capstone Design Manager is a web-based application developed for the University of Alabama Computer Science department. Its primary purpose is for managing senior design projects by connecting students with external sponsors who provide project ideas.

This system streamlines the entire process of project submission, gathering student preferences, matching students to projects, and other project management such as email management. It serves as a centralized platform where sponsors can submit projects and administrators can oversee the entire process from beginning to end.

User Roles

The system supports three distinct user roles, each with specific permissions and capabilities:

Role	Description	Primary Responsibility
Student	An enrolled UA Computer Science student who will be assigned to work on a senior design project	Browse projects, rank preferences, view assignment
Sponsor	An non-student professional from a company, organization or even from UA who submits project ideas for students to work on	Submit projects, provide feedback, track progress
Admin	A faculty member or staff administrator who manages the entire system	Manage all data, send emails, oversee process

Understanding the Workflow

The system follows a specific workflow that progresses through several stages throughout the semester:

Stage 1 - Project Submission: Sponsors log into the system and submit their project proposals. Each sponsor can submit multiple projects based on their organization's needs and the limit set by the administrator. Admins can send emails to sponsors for submitting projects and for presenting the projects to students in class.

Stage 2 - Student Preferences: After projects are submitted and reviewed, students log into the system to browse all available projects. Each student selects and ranks their top three choices in order of preference.

Stage 3 - Assignment: After the preference deadline passes, the system or administrator creates assignments that match students to projects based on their preferences and other factors.

Stage 4 - Project Execution: Students work on their assigned projects throughout the semester. Sponsors can view progress and provide feedback.

Stage 5 - Completion: Projects are marked as complete when the semester ends and deliverables are submitted.

System Features

The Capstone Design Manager provides the following features:

- **Project Submission Form:** A web-based form that sponsors use to submit their project ideas with detailed descriptions, requirements, and deliverables.
- **Project Browsing:** A searchable and filterable list of all available projects that students can browse to find projects that match their interests.
- **Preference Ranking System:** An intuitive system that allows students to rank their top three project choices in order of preference.
- **Automated Assignment:** A system that helps administrators create fair assignments based on student preferences.
- **Feedback System:** A messaging system that allows sponsors to communicate progress updates and concerns to students through the platform.
- **Attachment Management:** A file upload system that allows sponsors to share documents, images, and other relevant materials related to their projects.
- **Email Notification System:** An automated email system that sends notifications to sponsors and students about important updates, deadlines, and events.
- **Admin Control Panel:** A comprehensive administrative interface that provides full control over all aspects of the system.

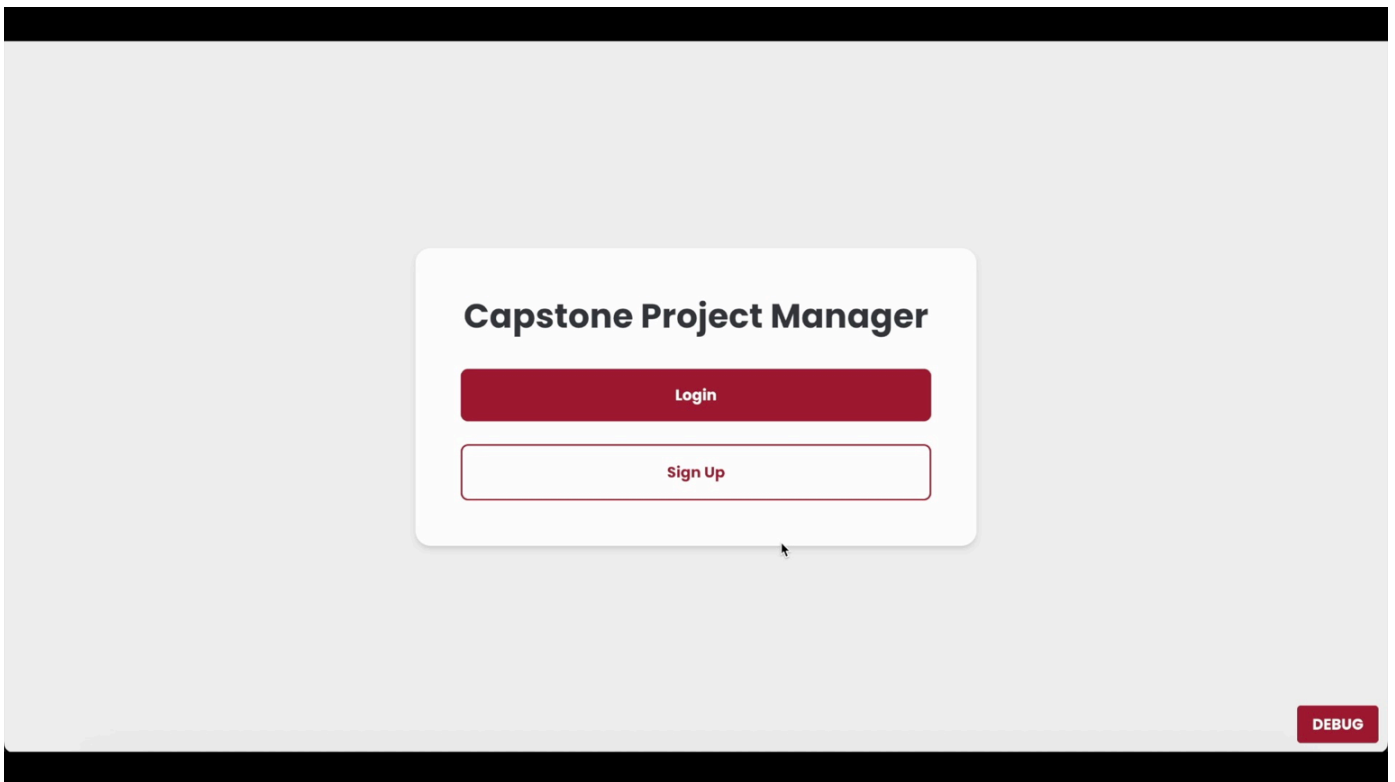
2. Getting Started

This section explains how to access and set up your account on the Capstone Design Manager application.

Accessing the Application

To access the Capstone Design Manager application, follow these steps:

1. Open your web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge are recommended).
2. Navigate to <https://ua-capstone-projects.com/>
3. You will see the landing page with options to Sign Up or Log In.



Understanding Authentication

The Capstone Design Manager uses OAuth for user authentication. OAuth is an industry-standard protocol that allows users to log in using third-party services (like Google or GitHub) without sharing passwords directly with the application.

How User Accounts Are Created

Sign-Up Process:

When a user signs up for the first time, their account is created automatically:

1. User clicks **Sign Up** on the landing page
2. User selects their role (Student or Sponsor)
3. User authenticates using their chosen method (Google, GitHub, or email/password)
4. The system creates a user account
5. A verification email is sent to the user's email address
6. User clicks the verification link in the email

7. The verified user can now log in

Role Assignment:

- **Students:** The "student" role is automatically assigned when signing up as a student
- **Sponsors:** The "sponsor" role is automatically assigned when signing up as a sponsor
- **Admins:** The "admin" role must be manually assigned by an administrator

Logging In:

1. User clicks **Log In**
2. User authenticates using their chosen method
3. The system verifies their identity and creates a session

Creating a New Account (Sign Up)

If you do not have an account yet, follow these steps to sign up:

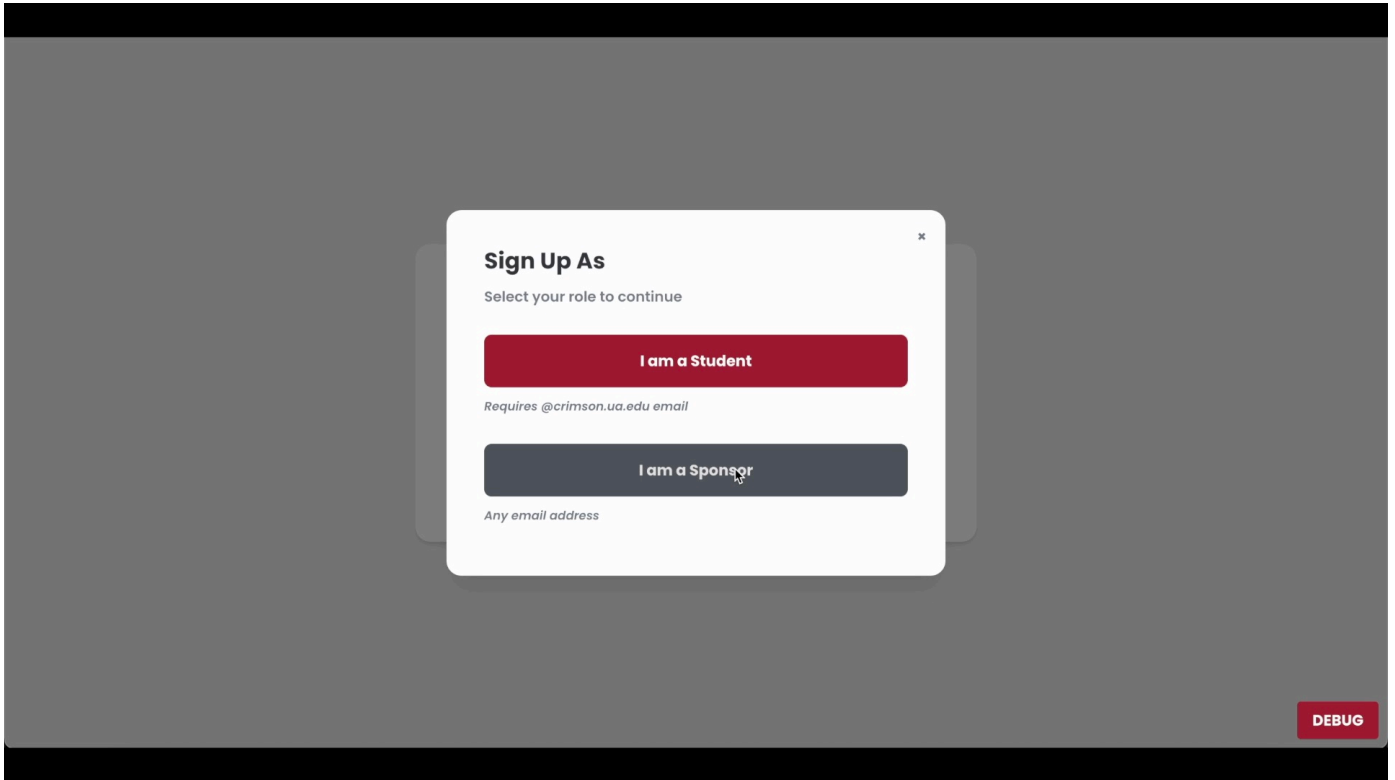
1. Click the **Sign Up** button on the landing page.
2. You will be prompted to select your role. Choose one of the following:
 - **I am a Student** - Select this if you are enrolled in the capstone class
 - **I am a Sponsor** - Select this if you are providing project ideas as an external professional
3. Complete the sign-up process using your chosen authentication method:
 - For students: Enter your @crimson.ua.edu email and follow the prompts
 - For sponsors: Either sign in with Google/GitHub or create an email/password account
4. Check your email inbox for a verification email.
5. Click the verification link to confirm your email address.
6. Once verified, you can log in to the application.

Logging Into Your Account

To log in after creating your account:

1. Click the **Log In** button on the landing page.
2. Choose your authentication method (Google, GitHub, or email/password).

3. Complete the authentication process.
4. You will be redirected to your dashboard based on your role.

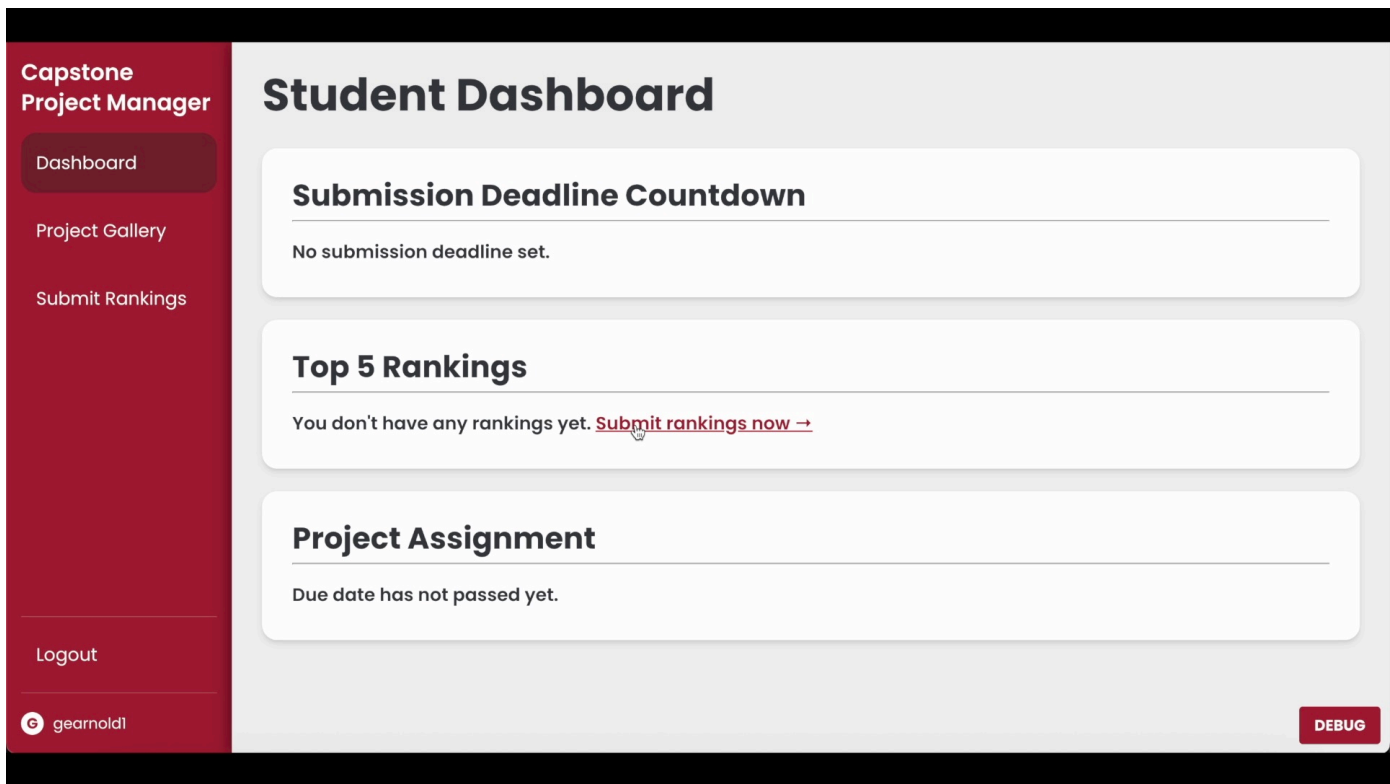


3. Student Guide

This section provides detailed instructions for students on how to use the Capstone Design Manager.

Understanding the Student Dashboard

After successfully logging in, you will be taken to your Student Dashboard. This is your home page within the application and provides an overview of your status.



The Student Dashboard displays the following information:

- **Submission:** Status of your rankings submission
- **Top 5 Rankings:** Your highest ranked projects
- **Project Assignment:** The project you have been assigned to (visible after the assignment date)

Navigating the Student Interface

The student interface includes a sidebar with the following menu options:

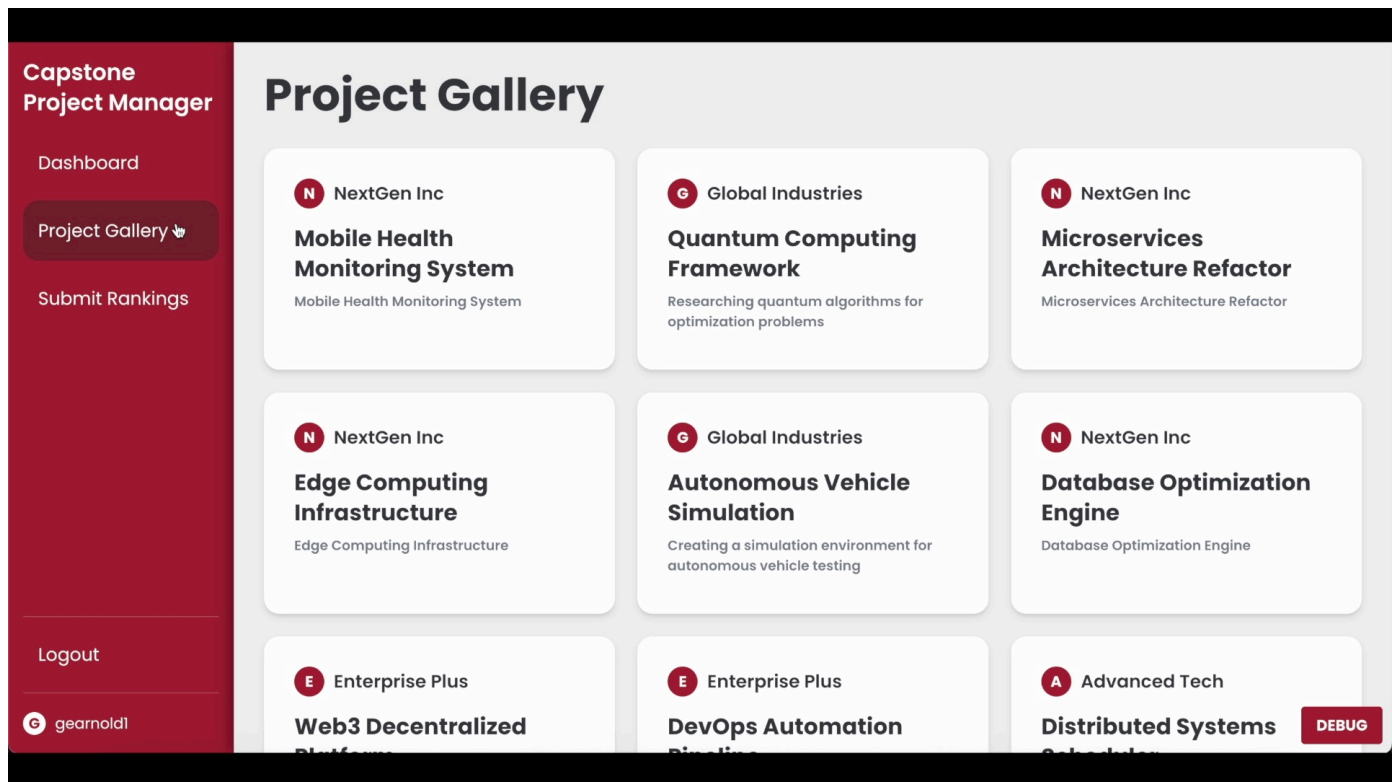
- **Dashboard:** View your dashboard
- **Dashboard:** View your dashboard
- **Submit/Edit Rankings:** Submit and manage your project rankings
- **Project Gallery:** Browse all available projects
- **Logout:** Log out of the application

How to View All Available Projects

To browse all projects that are available for the current semester:

1. Locate the sidebar on the left side of the screen.

2. Click on **Project Gallery**.
3. You will see a list of all projects that have been submitted by sponsors.



The project list displays each project with:

- **Project Name:** The title of the project
- **Sponsor Organization:** The company or organization providing the project
- **Brief Description:** A short summary of the project (first 100-150 characters)
- **Status:** The current status of the project

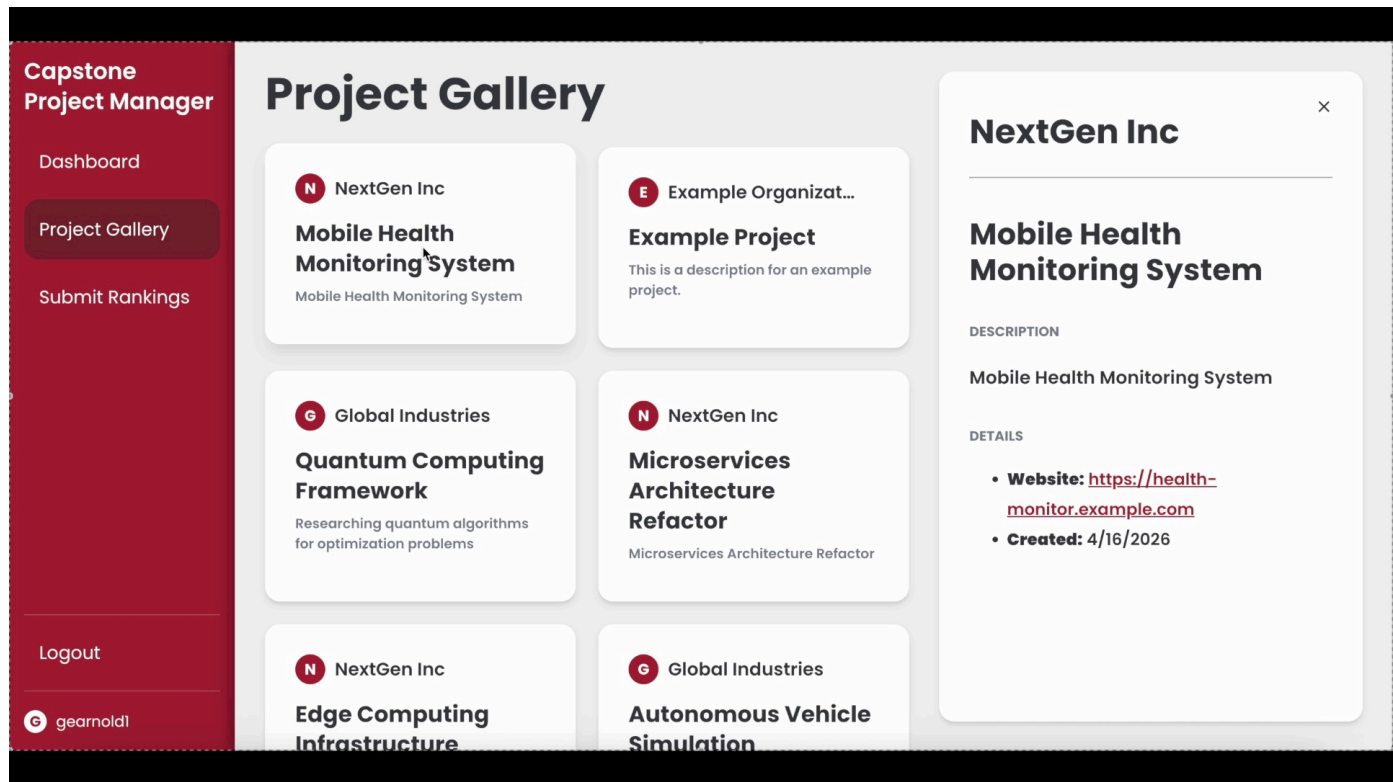
Understanding Project Status Values:

Status	Meaning
Pending	The project has been submitted but not yet started
In Progress	The project is active and students are working on it
Complete	The project has been finished
Cancelled	The project will not proceed

How to View Detailed Project Information

To see all details about a specific project:

1. From the **Project Gallery** page, click on the project name or the View/Edit icon.
2. A detailed view of the project will open.



The project details page shows:

- **Full Description:** Complete details about the project including goals, requirements, and deliverables
- **Sponsor Information:** The name of the sponsor and their organization
- **Website Link:** A link to additional information (if provided by the sponsor)
- **Feedback:** Progress updates from the sponsor

How to Submit Your Preferences

As a student, you can rank projects in order of preference. Your rankings are important because they help determine your final project assignment.

To submit or update your preferences:

1. Navigate to **Submit Rankings** from the sidebar.
2. Browse the list of available projects.
3. Click the **Rank** button on a project you are interested in.

4. Select your preferred rank number from the dropdown:
 - **Rank 1:** First choice (most wanted)
 - **Rank 2:** Second choice
 - **Rank 3:** Third choice (least wanted)
5. Click **Save** to confirm your ranking.
6. Repeat these steps for other projects.

Project Name	High	Medium	Low
Mobile Health Monitoring System	☒	☐	☐
Example Project	☐	☐	☐
Quantum Computing Framework	☐	☐	☐
Microservices Architecture Refactor	☐	☐	☐
Edge Computing Infrastructure	☐	☐	☐
Autonomous Vehicle Simulation	☐	☐	☐
Database Optimization Engine	☐	☐	☐
Mobile Banking Application	☐	☐	☐
Web3 Decentralized Platform	☐	☐	☐

Important Rules for Preferences:

- Each student can rank a maximum of 15 projects total.
- You can rank up to 5 projects per rank level (Rank 1, Rank 2, Rank 3).
- You cannot assign the same rank number to more than 5 projects (Rank 1 is for up to 5 projects only, Rank 2 is for up to 5 projects only, etc.).
- You can change your rankings at any time before the preference deadline.
- After the deadline passes, your preferences are locked and cannot be changed.
- Not ranking any projects may result in a random assignment.

How to View and Manage Your Preferences

To view your current rankings:

1. Click on **My Preferences** in the sidebar.
2. You will see a list of your ranked projects with their rank numbers.
3. From this page, you can:
 - View your current rankings
 - Change the rank of a project
 - Remove a project from your preferences

The screenshot displays the 'Capstone Project Manager' interface. On the left is a dark red sidebar with the title 'Capstone Project Manager' and navigation links: 'Dashboard', 'Project Gallery', 'Submit Rankings' (highlighted), 'Logout', and a user profile 'gearnoldl'. The main content area is white and contains a table of projects with three empty radio buttons for ranking. Below the table are three green buttons labeled 'High 5/5', 'Med 5/5', and 'Low 5/5'. A text prompt asks for additional information, followed by a text input field containing the text 'I have some music listening to do in my spare time honestly.'. At the bottom is a large red button labeled 'Submit Project Rankings'.

AI-Powered Chatbot Platform	☐	☐	☐
Computer Vision Quality Control	☐	☐	☐
Cloud Data Analytics Dashboard	☐	☐	☐
Cybersecurity Threat Detection	☐	☐	☐
Advanced Image Recognition Engine	☐	☐	☐
Network Security Audit Tool	☐	☐	☐

High 5/5 Med 5/5 Low 5/5

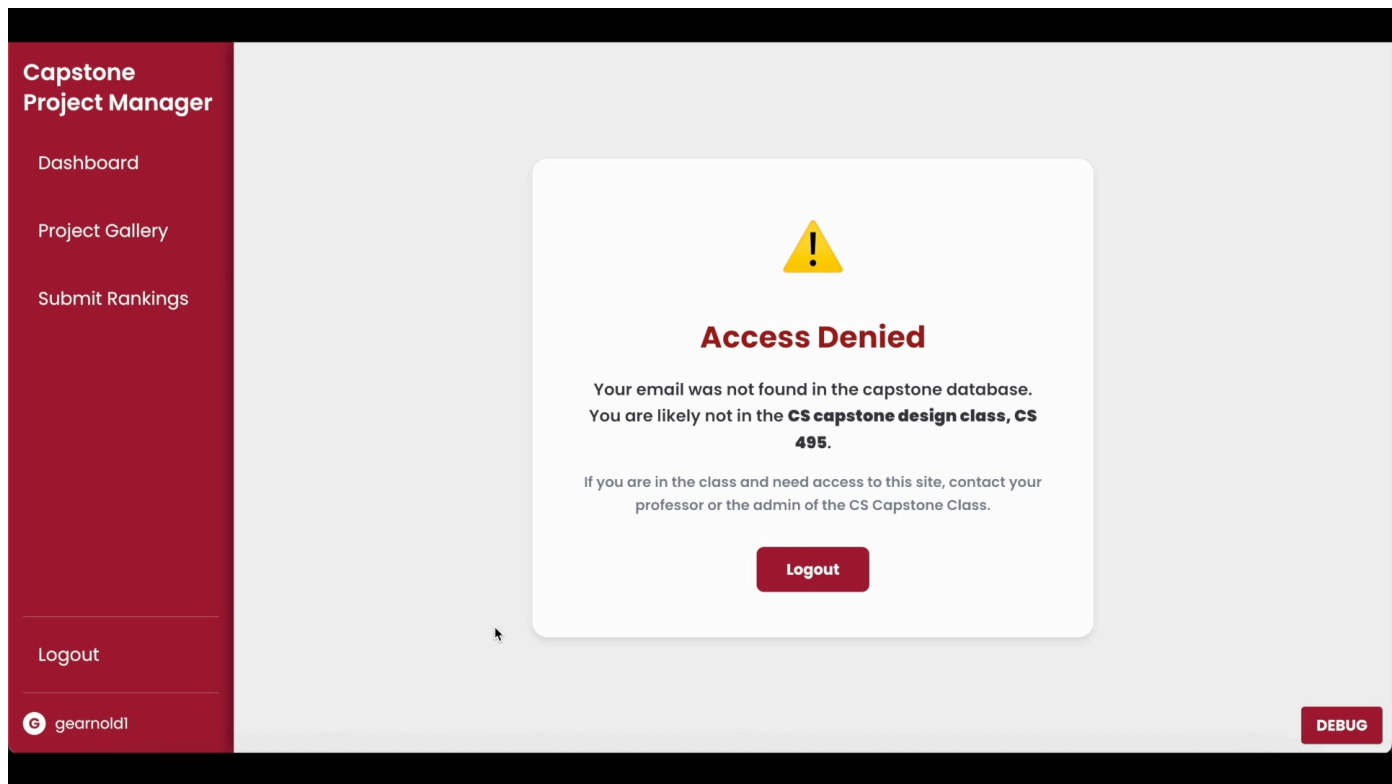
Provide any additional information. We will not be able to accommodate all requests.

I have some music listening to do in my spare time honestly.

Submit Project Rankings

What to Do If You See "Not Registered"

If upon logging in you see a message indicating "Not Registered" or you cannot access student features:



This message appears when your account exists in the system but your student record has not been created in the database. To resolve this:

1. Contact your course instructor or the system administrator.
2. Ask them to add your student record to the database using your CWID.
3. Provide them with your:
 - Full name
 - CWID (8-digit number)
 - Email address (@crimson.ua.edu)
 - Major code
 - Class year

How to Update Your Profile

To update your personal information:

1. Select **Edit Profile** from the sidebar.
2. Update the following fields:

Field	Description	Notes
First	Your first	

Name	name	Must match your university records
Last Name	Your last name	Must match your university records
Email	Your email address	Must be @crimson.ua.edu
Major Code	Your major	Examples: CS, CYS
Class Year	Your class standing	FR (Freshman), SO (Sophomore), JR (Junior), SR (Senior), GR (Graduate)

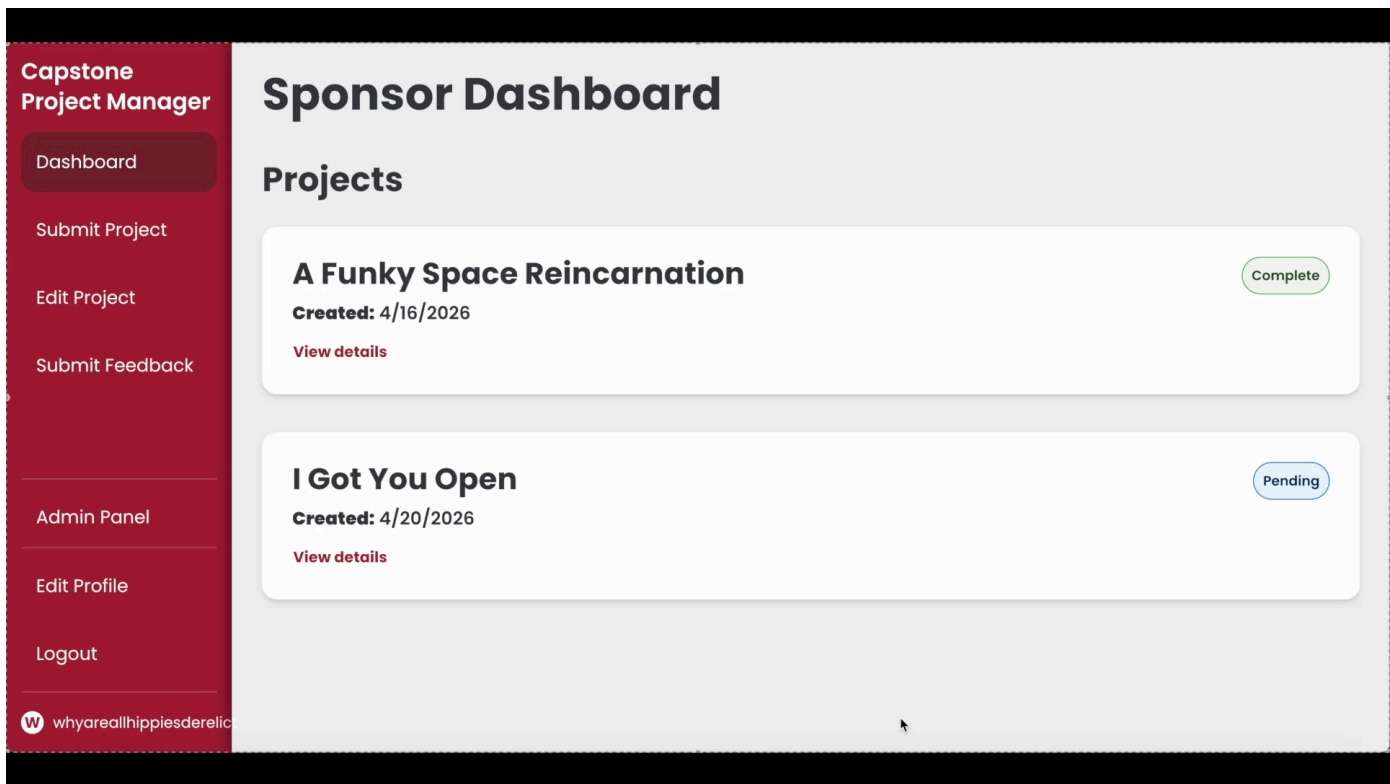
3. Click **Save** to confirm your changes.

4. Sponsor Guide

This section provides detailed instructions for sponsors on how to use the Capstone Design Manager.

Understanding the Sponsor Dashboard

After logging in, you will see your Sponsor Dashboard. This is your main page within the application.



The Sponsor Dashboard displays:

- **Your Organization:** Your company or organization name
- **Projects Submitted:** The number of projects you have submitted
- **Project List:** A table showing your submitted projects with their current status

Navigating the Sponsor Interface

The sponsor interface includes a sidebar with the following menu options:

- **Dashboard:** View your dashboard and project summary
- **Submit Project:** Submit a new project idea
- **Project Dashboard:** View and manage your submitted projects
- **Project Gallery:** Browse all projects in the system
- **Profile:** Update your organization information

How to Submit a Submit Project

To submit a new project idea for students to work on:

1. Click on **Submit Project** in the sidebar.
2. A project submission form will appear.

Capstone Project Manager

Dashboard

Submit Project

Edit Project

Submit Feedback

Admin Panel

Edit Profile

Logout

whyareallhippiesderelic

Project Submission

Thank you for your interest in sponsoring a computer science capstone projects. Our students have spent 4 years acquiring skills. The opportunity to have a culminating experience that incorporates everything they have learned is invaluable. your willingness to be a part of that experience appreciated. At the same time, we are honored to contribute to the university community.

When presenting your project, students will want to know the purpose of the system, who will be using it, and what users should be able to do. It is helpful to provide information on how the users will access the systems and how many users you expect.

External Sponsor/Student Agreement

Project sponsors will:

- Provide students with a list of user interactions and functionality (what the software should do).
- Meet with students weekly to prioritize feature implementation.
- Provide frequent feedback on how well the software meets the business requirements.
- Provide timely answers to questions.

Students will:

- Choose tools, language and platforms that are appropriate for the requirements.

3. Fill in the following fields:

Field	Required	Description
Project Name	Yes	A clear, descriptive title for your project
Description	Yes	Detailed information about the project including goals, deliverables, and requirements
Website	No	A link to additional information about the project or your organization

4. Click the **Submit Project** button to save your project.

Tips for Writing a Good Project Description:

A well-written project description helps students understand your expectations and decide if the project matches their skills. Include the following information:

- **Project Goal:** What is the main objective or problem you are trying to solve?
- **Deliverables:** What specific items should students produce? (prototype, documentation, presentation, etc.)
- **Required Skills:** What technical skills or programming languages are needed?

- **Team Size:** How many students do you want working on this project? (typically 3-5)
- **Timeline:** Are there important milestones or deadlines?
- **Constraints:** Are there any budgetary, equipment, or other limitations?

How to View and Manage Your Projects

To view all projects you have submitted:

1. Click on **Project Dashboard** in the sidebar.
2. A list of your submitted projects will be displayed.

For each project, you can see:

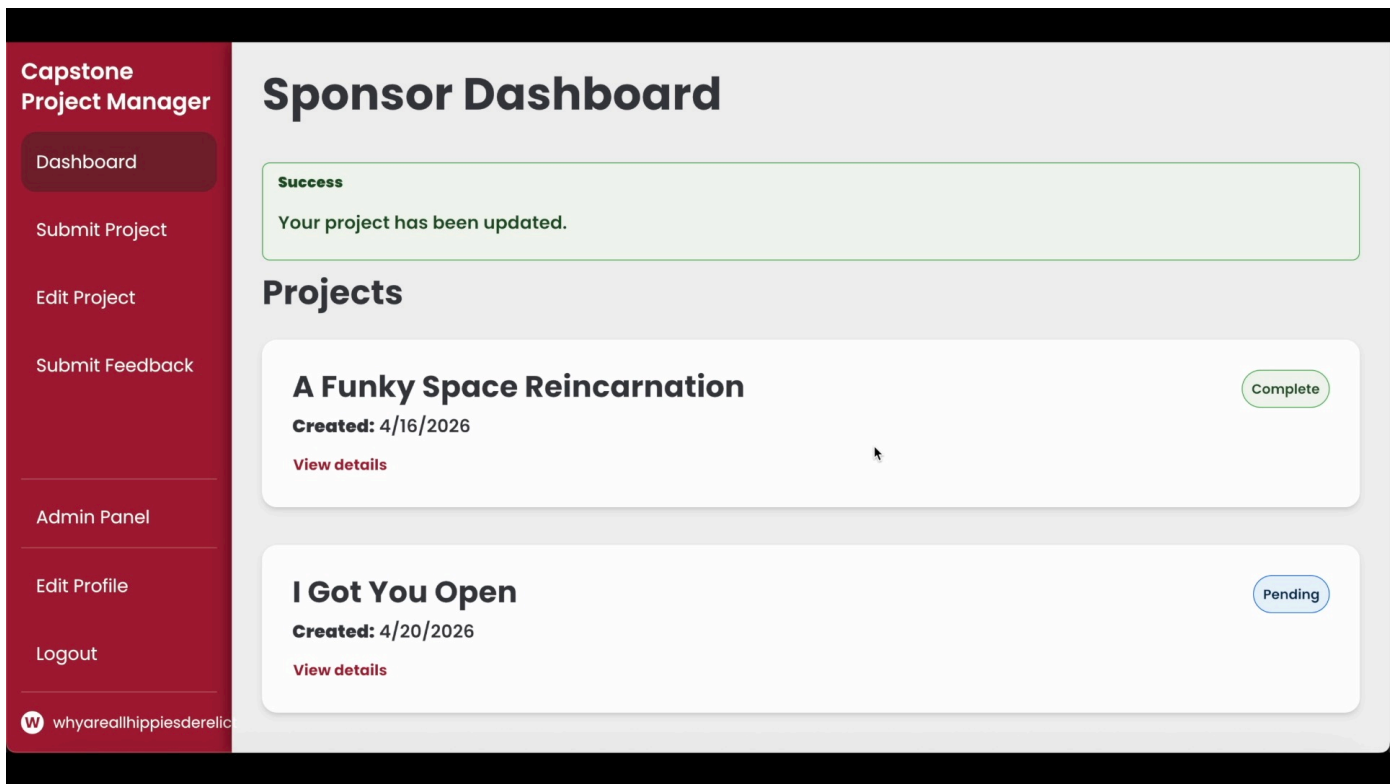
- **Project Name:** The title of the project
- **Status:** Current status (Pending, In Progress, Complete, Cancelled)
- **Students Assigned:** Number of students assigned to the project

How to Edit a Project

To make changes to a project you have submitted:

1. Go to **Project Dashboard**.
2. Click on the project you want to edit.
3. Click the **Edit Project** button.
4. Update the fields as needed.
5. Click **Save Changes** to confirm your updates.





Note: You can only edit projects that have not yet been assigned to students, or edit the description/sponsor fields of assigned projects.

How to Submit Feedback About a Project

You can provide feedback to communicate with students working on your project:

1. Go to **Project Dashboard**.
2. Click on the project you want to add feedback for.
3. Click the **Submit Feedback** button.
4. Enter your feedback message in the text box.
5. Click **Submit** to save your feedback.

Capstone Project Manager

Dashboard

Submit Project

Edit Project

Submit Feedback

Admin Panel

Edit Profile

Logout

whyareallhippiesderelic

Feedback Submission

Select Semester

Fall 2026

Select a Project

☒ A Funky Space Reincarnation
 ☐ I Got You Open

Feedback

I need more of something going for a Marvin Gaye or Blackbyrds sort of music thing in what I saw and heard. The demos were good. They just need to be better

Submit Sponsor Feedback

What to Include in Feedback:

- Progress updates and observations
- Issues that need addressing
- Questions for the students
- Additional work
- Recommendations for improvement
- Comments at the end of the semester

Assigned Students

When the semester start date passes and students are assigned to projects:

Dashboard.

Click on the

"Assigned Students" section.

This is a list of students assigned to your project.

Each student played with:

• Student's full name

• Student's Campus-Wide ID

Project Video

Backlog

Cyber Security

Features

Deployment

User Guide

Development

FAQs

Testing

← Home

Documentation

Authors

- **Email:** Student's email address

How to Update Your Profile

To update your organization and contact information:

1. Select **Edit Profile** from the sidebar.
2. Update the following fields:

Field	Description
Organization	Your company or organization name
Phone Number	Your contact phone number
Website	Your organization website (optional)

3. Click **Save** to confirm your changes.

Capstone Project Manager

Dashboard

Submit Project

Edit Project

Submit Feedback

Admin Panel

Edit Profile

Logout

Edit Profile

Email: whyareallhippiesderelict@gmail.com

Make changes to your profile.

First Name: Here My

Last Name: Dear

Organization: Here It Is

Phone Number: 205-555-2384

Update Profile

5. Admin Guide

This section provides detailed instructions for administrators on how to use the Django admin panel.

Understanding Admin Access

There are two steps required to gain Django admin access in this system:

Step 1 - Create a Sponsor Account: You must first create a user account in the system by signing up as a sponsor. Follow the sponsor sign-up process described in the Getting Started section.

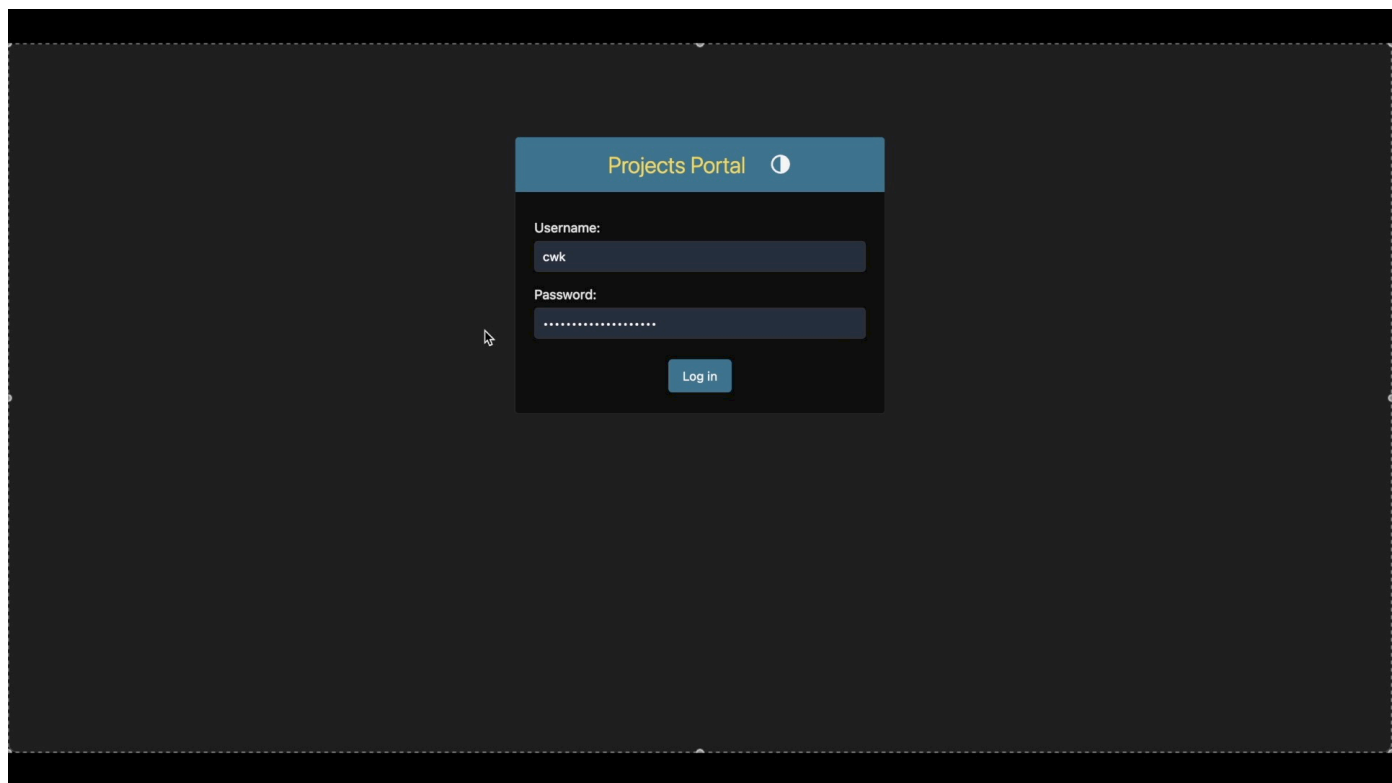
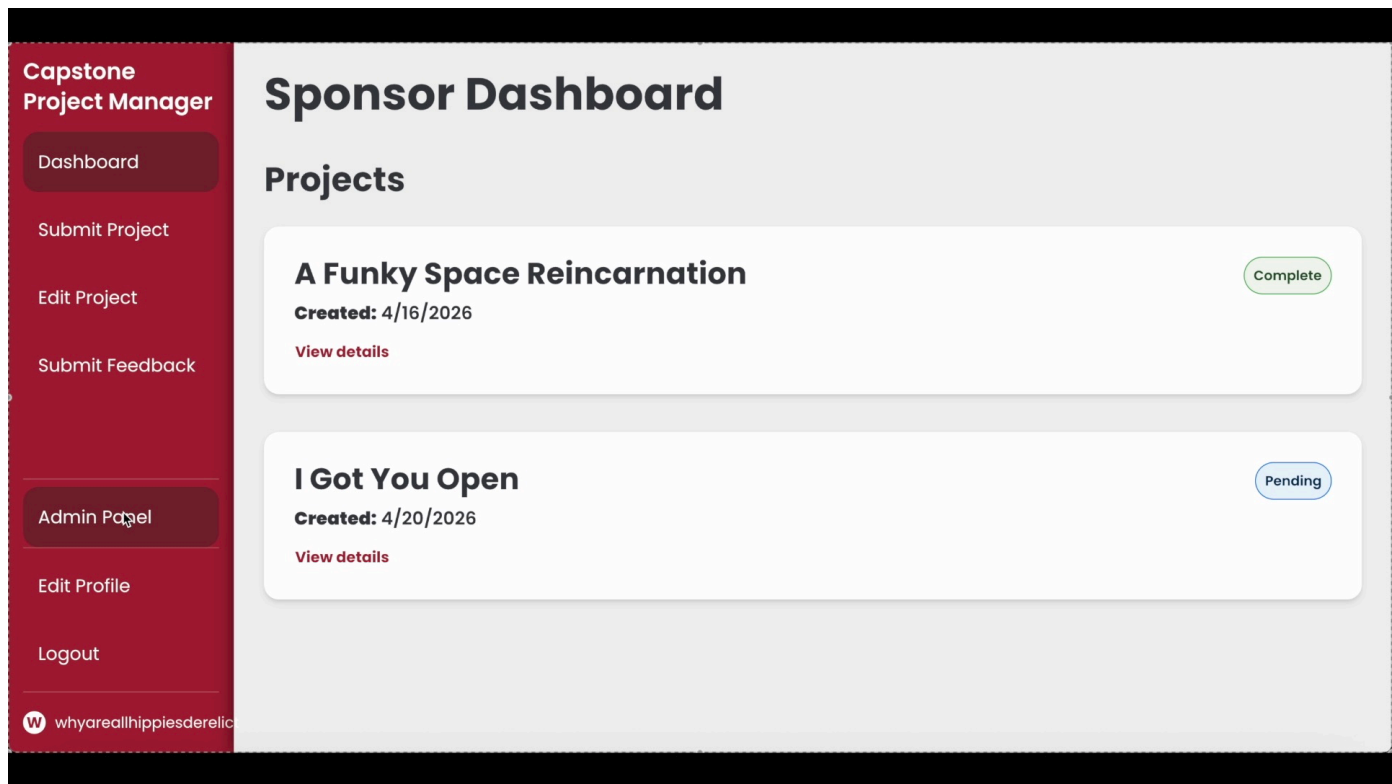
Step 2 - Assign Admin Role: The system administrator must assign the 'admin' role to your account.

Step 3 - Create Django Superuser: After logging in with your sponsor account and seeing the admin button, you need to create your Django superuser credentials or have an existing administrator create them for you.

Accessing the Admin Panel

Once you have completed the steps above, follow these instructions to access the admin panel:

1. Log in to the application with your sponsor account.
2. After logging in, look for the **Admin** button in the navigation.
3. Click the **Admin** button.
4. You will be redirected to the Django admin login page.
5. Enter your Django superuser credentials (username and password).
6. Click **Log In** to access the admin panel.

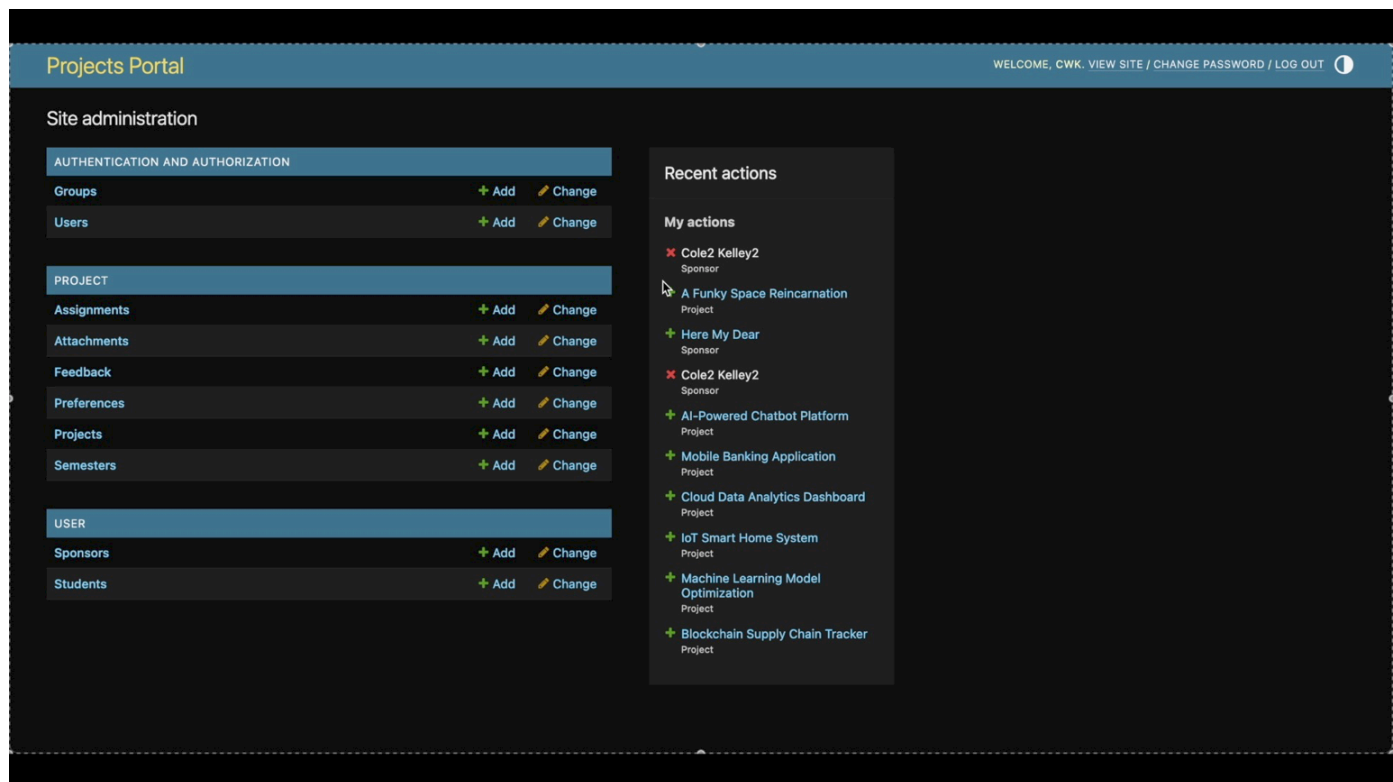


Note: If you do not see the Admin button after logging in, your account has not been assigned the admin role yet. Contact the system administrator to assign the 'admin' role to your account.

Admin Panel Navigation

The admin panel is organized into sections:

- **PROJECT:** Contains all project-related data
 - Projects
 - Semesters
 - Preferences
 - Assignments
 - Attachments
 - Feedback
- **USER:** Contains all user-related data
 - Sponsors
 - Students
- **AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION:** Django authentication system
 - Users
 - Groups



Managing Students

To add or edit student records:

1. In the admin panel, click on **Students** under the USER section.

2. Click **Add Student** to create a new student, or click on an existing student to edit.

Start typing to filter...

AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION

Groups + Add

Users + Add

PROJECT

Assignments + Add

Attachments + Add

Feedback + Add

Preferences + Add

Projects + Add

Semesters + Add

USER

Sponsors + Add

Students + Add

Select student to change

IMPORT EXPORT ADD STUDENT +

Search

Action: ----- Go 0 of 100 selected

☐	CWID	NAME	EMAIL	MAJOR	CLASS
☐	12280196	Daniel Allen	daniel.allen6430@example.com	-	-
☐	12219898	James Allen	james.allen646@example.com	EE	-
☐	12240943	James Allen	james.allen162@example.com	-	-
☐	12206655	John Allen	john.allen3132@example.com	-	-
☐	12223975	Matthew Allen	matthew.allen9210@example.com	CYS	-
☐	12250306	Michelle Allen	michelle.allen2506@example.com	-	-
☐	12297192	Susan Allen	susan.allen6623@example.com	-	-
☐	12259036	Donald Anderson	donald.anderson9592@example.com	-	-
☐	12284685	Thomas Anderson	thomas.anderson8314@example.com	CE	-
☐	12345679	Bob Baker	bob@ua.edu	CS	Senior
☐	12225440	James Brown	james.brown2339@example.com	CE	-
☐	12288409	Anthony Clark	anthony.clark9855@example.com	-	-
☐	12242438	Ashley Clark	ashley.clark1112@example.com	-	-
☐	12345680	Charlie Clark	charlie@ua.edu	CS	Senior
☐	12246454	Jennifer Clark	jennifer.clark1696@example.com	CE	-
☐	12273086	Thomas Clark	thomas.clark7637@example.com	EE	-

FILTER

Show counts

By major

All

456

CE

CS

CYS

EE

By class

All

Freshman

Sophomore

Junior

Senior

Graduate

Student Fields:

Field	Description	Required	Notes
CWID	8-digit Campus-Wide ID	Yes	Must be unique
First Name	Student's first name	Yes	
Last Name	Student's last name	Yes	
Email	Student's email address	Yes	Must be @crimson.ua.edu
Major Code	Major of study	Yes	CS, CYS, etc.
Class Code	Class year	Yes	FR, SO, JR, SR, GR

To Add a New Student:

1. Click the **Add Student** button.
2. Fill in all required fields.
3. Click the **Save** button to create the student record.

Projects Portal

WELCOME, MRGERMANDUDE. [VIEW SITE](#) / [CHANGE PASSWORD](#) / [LOG OUT](#)

Home > User > Students > Add student

Start typing to filter...

AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION

Groups

+ Add

Users

+ Add

PROJECT

Assignments

+ Add

Attachments

+ Add

Feedback

+ Add

Preferences

+ Add

Projects

+ Add

Semesters

+ Add

USER

Sponsors

+ Add

Students

+ Add

Add student

Cwid:

12345678

First name:

Gates

Middle name:

Last name:

Arnold

Preferred name:

Email:

gearnold1@crimson.ua.edu

Description:

Class:

Major:

ID:

-

Projects Portal

WELCOME, MRGERMANDUDE. VIEW SITE / CHANGE PASSWORD / LOG OUT

Home > User > Students

Start typing to filter...

AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION

Groups + Add

Users + Add

PROJECT

Assignments + Add

Attachments + Add

Feedback + Add

Preferences + Add

Projects + Add

Semesters + Add

USER

Sponsors + Add

Students + Add

✔ The student "Gates Arnold" was added successfully.

Select student to change

Search

Search

Action: ----- Go 0 of 100 selected

☐	CWID	NAME	EMAIL	MAJOR	CLASS
☐	12280196	Daniel Allen	daniel.allen6430@example.com	-	-
☐	12219898	James Allen	james.allen646@example.com	EE	-
☐	12240943	James Allen	james.allen162@example.com	-	-
☐	12206655	John Allen	john.allen3132@example.com	-	-
☐	12223975	Matthew Allen	matthew.allen9210@example.com	CYS	-
☐	12250306	Michelle Allen	michelle.allen2506@example.com	-	-
☐	12297192	Susan Allen	susan.allen6623@example.com	-	-
☐	12259036	Donald Anderson	donald.anderson9592@example.com	-	-
☐	12284685	Thomas Anderson	thomas.anderson8314@example.com	CE	-
☐	12340581	Gates Arnold	gearnold1@crimson.ua.edu	CS	Senior
☐	12345679	Bob Baker	bob@ua.edu	CS	Senior
☐	12225440	James Brown	james.brown2339@example.com	CE	-
☐	12288409	Anthony Clark	anthony.clark9855@example.com	-	-

FILTER

Show counts

By major

All

456

CE

CS

CYS

EE

By class

All

Freshman

Sophomore

Junior

Senior

Graduate

Managing Sponsors

To add or edit sponsor records:

1. Click on **Sponsors** under the USER section.
2. Click **Add Sponsor** to create a new sponsor, or click on an existing sponsor to edit.

Projects Portal

WELCOME, CWK. VIEW SITE / CHANGE PASSWORD / LOG OUT

Home > User > Sponsors

Start typing to filter...

AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION

Groups + Add

Users + Add

PROJECT

Assignments + Add

Attachments + Add

Feedback + Add

Preferences + Add

Projects + Add

Semesters + Add

USER

Sponsors + Add

Students + Add

Select sponsor to change

Q

Search

Action: -----

Go

0 of 21 selected

☐	NAME	EMAIL	PROJECTS	ORGANIZATION
☐	c c	a564021@hotmail.com	0	c
☐	Jennifer Davis	jennifer.davis187@example.com	0	NextGen Inc
☐	Sarah Davis	sarah.davis322@example.com	0	Enterprise Plus
☐	Here My Dear	whyareallhipplesderelict@gmail.com	2	Here It Is
☐	John Doe	johndoe@crimson.ua.edu	0	University of Alabama
☐	John Doe2	shkorodi@crimson.ua.edu	0	University of Alabama
☐	John Doe3	sammy.k5890@gmail.com	0	University of Alabama
☐	John Doe4	gagora1463@dwseal.com	0	University of Alabama
☐	Robert Garcia	robert.garcia345@example.com	2	Innovation Labs
☐	Jessica Hernandez	jessica.hernandez968@example.com	2	Enterprise Plus
☐	David Johnson	david.johnson417@example.com	1	Tech Corp
☐	cole kelley	colewalkerkelley@gmail.com	2	Stupid
☐	Jane Lopez	jane.lopez590@example.com	2	Advanced Tech
☐	Sarah Lopez	sarah.lopez663@example.com	3	Global Industries

IMPORT

EXPORT

ADD SPONSOR +

FILTER

Show counts

By organization

All

Advanced Tech

c

Enterprise Plus

Example

Example Organization

Global Industries

Here It Is

Innovation Labs

NextGen Inc

Stupid

Tech Corp

University of Alabama

Sponsor Fields:

Field	Description	Required	Notes
First Name	Sponsor's first name	Yes	
Last Name	Sponsor's last name	Yes	
Email	Sponsor's email address	Yes	Must be unique
Organization	Company or organization name	Yes	
Phone Number	Contact phone number	No	
Projects Allowed	Maximum projects this sponsor can submit	Yes	Default is usually 3

Managing Projects

To add or edit project records:

1. Click on **Projects** under the PROJECT section.
2. Click **Add Project** to create a new project, or click on an existing project to edit.

Projects Portal

WELCOME, CWK. VIEW SITE / CHANGE PASSWORD / LOG OUT

Home > Project > Projects

Start typing to filter...

AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION

Groups + Add

Users + Add

PROJECT

Assignments + Add

Attachments + Add

Feedback + Add

Preferences + Add

Projects + Add

Semesters + Add

USER

Sponsors + Add

Students + Add

Select project to change

Q

Search

Action: -----

Go

0 of 26 selected

☐	NAME	SPONSOR	STATUS	SEMESTERS
☐	API Gateway Enhancement	Jennifer Martinez	Pending	0
☐	AR/VR Training Simulator	Jennifer Martinez	Pending	0
☐	Cloud Data Analytics Dashboard	Jennifer Martinez	Pending	0
☐	Computer Vision Quality Control	John Rodriguez	Pending	0
☐	DevOps Automation Pipeline	Jessica Hernandez	Pending	0
☐	Example Project	Cole Munn	Pending	0
☐	I Got You Open	Here My Dear	Pending	0
☐	Mobile Banking Application	cole kelley	Pending	0
☐	Quantum Computing Framework	Sarah Lopez	Pending	0
☐	Real-time Collaboration Suite	Robert Garcia	Pending	0
☐	Advanced Image Recognition Engine	David Johnson	In Progress	0
☐	Autonomous Vehicle Simulation	Sarah Lopez	In Progress	0
☐	Database Optimization Engine	John Rodriguez	In Progress	0
☐	Enterprise Resource Planning System	Sarah Lopez	In Progress	0

IMPORT

EXPORT

ADD PROJECT +

FILTER

Show counts

By status

All

In Progress

Cancelled

Complete

Pending

By sponsor

All

c c

Jennifer Davis

Sarah Davis

Here My Dear

John Doe

John Doe2

John Doe3

John Doe4

Robert Garcia

Jessica Hernandez

David Johnson

cole kelley

Jane Lopez

Sarah Lopez

Jennifer Martinez

Project Fields:

Field	Description	Required	Notes
Name	Project title	Yes	
Description	Full project description	Yes	
Sponsor	Sponsor who submitted the project	Yes	Select from dropdown
Status	Current status	Yes	See status values below
Website	External link	No	

Status Values:

Status Code	Meaning	Description
PNDG	Pending	Project has been submitted but not yet started
IP	In Progress	Students are actively working on the project
CMPL	Complete	Project has been finished successfully

CNCL

Cancelled

Project will not proceed

Project Actions:

From the projects list, you can perform bulk actions:

- **Change Status:** Select multiple projects and change their status in bulk
- **Assign to Semester:** Add selected projects to a specific semester
- **Remove from Semester:** Remove selected projects from a semester

The screenshot displays the 'Projects Portal' interface. At the top, a green banner indicates 'Status changed to Cmpl for 2 projects.' The left sidebar contains navigation links for 'AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION' (Groups, Users), 'PROJECT' (Assignments, Attachments, Feedback, Preferences, Projects, Semesters), and 'USER' (Sponsors, Students). The main content area is titled 'Select project to change' and shows a table with 2 results (26 total). A dropdown menu is open over the 'Action' column, listing: 'Delete selected projects', 'Change status', 'Assign to a semester', and 'Remove from semester'. The table columns are SPONSOR, STATUS, and SEMESTERS. The right sidebar includes a 'FILTER' section with options for 'Show counts', 'Clear all filters', 'By status' (All, In Progress, Cancelled, Complete, Pending), and 'By sponsor' (All, c c, Jennifer Davis, Sarah Davis, Here My Dear, John Doe, John Doe2, John Doe3, John Doe4, Robert Garcia, Jessica Hernandez, David Johnson).

SPONSOR	STATUS	SEMESTERS
Here My Dear	Complete	0
Here My Dear	Complete	0

Managing Semesters

To create and manage semesters:

1. Click on **Semesters** under the PROJECT section.
2. Click **Add Semester** to create a new semester.

Projects Portal

WELCOME, CWK. [VIEW SITE](#) / [CHANGE PASSWORD](#) / [LOG OUT](#)

Home > Project > Semesters

Start typing to filter...

AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION

Groups + Add

Users + Add

PROJECT

Assignments + Add

Attachments + Add

Feedback + Add

Preferences + Add

Projects + Add

Semesters + Add

USER

Sponsors + Add

Students + Add

The semester "Spring 2027" was added successfully.

Select semester to change

IMPORTEXPORTADD SEMESTER +

SEARCH

Search

Action: Go 0 of 2 selected

SEMESTER	YEAR	ASSIGNMENT DATE	PROJECTS
☐ Spring	2027	Jan. 11, 2027, 6 p.m.	1
☐ Fall	2026	Aug. 24, 2026, 6 p.m.	26

2 semesters

FILTER

Show counts

By year

All

2026

2027

By semester

All

Fall

Spring

Summer

Semester Fields:

Field	Description	Required	Notes
Semester	Academic term	Yes	Fall, Spring, or Summer
Year	Academic year	Yes	4-digit year (e.g., 2026)
Assignment Date	Deadline for student preferences	Yes	Date and time when preferences are locked

The screenshot shows the 'Add semester' form in the Projects Portal. The left sidebar contains a navigation menu with sections: AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION (Groups, Users), PROJECT (Assignments, Attachments, Feedback, Preferences, Projects, Semesters), and USER (Sponsors, Students). The main form area is titled 'Add semester' and includes fields for Semester (Spring), Year (2027), and Assignment date (Date: 2027-01-11, Time: 18:00:00). Below these fields is a list of projects to choose from, including API Gateway Enhancement, AR/VR Training Simulator, Cloud Data Analytics Dashboard, Computer Vision Quality Control, DevOps Automation Pipeline, Example Project, Mobile Banking Application, Quantum Computing Framework, and Real-time Collaboration Suite. At the bottom are buttons for SAVE, Save and add another, and Save and continue editing.

Managing Preferences

To view student preferences:

1. Click on **Preferences** under the PROJECT section.
2. View all student project rankings.

The preferences view shows:

- **Student:** The student who submitted the preference
- **Project:** The project being ranked
- **Rank:** The preference rank (1, 2, or 3)
- **Created:** When the preference was submitted

Admin Actions for Preferences:

- From the preferences list, you can select students and assign them to a project manually.

Managing Assignments

To view and create student assignments:

1. Click on **Assignments** under the PROJECT section.
2. View current student-to-project assignments.

The assignments view shows:

- **Student:** The assigned student
- **Project:** The project they are assigned to
- **Created:** When the assignment was made

Creating Assignments:

Assignments can be created using:

- The "Assign selected students to project" admin action
- The assignment algorithm endpoint

Managing Feedback

To view feedback from sponsors:

1. Click on **Feedback** under the PROJECT section.
2. View all feedback messages.

The screenshot shows the 'Projects Portal' interface. The top navigation bar includes 'Home > Project > Feedback' and user options like 'WELCOME, CWK. VIEW SITE / CHANGE PASSWORD / LOG OUT'. A left sidebar contains a menu with sections: 'AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION' (Groups, Users), 'PROJECT' (Assignments, Attachments, Feedback, Preferences, Projects, Semesters), and 'USER' (Sponsors, Students). The main content area is titled 'Select feedback to change' and features a search bar, an 'Action:' dropdown, and a 'Go' button. Below this is a table with columns 'ID', 'SPONSOR', and 'PROJECT'. One row is visible with 'Here My Dear' as the sponsor and 'A Funky Space Reincarnation' as the project. A '1 feedback' count is shown. On the right, there are 'IMPORT', 'EXPORT', and 'ADD FEEDBACK +' buttons, and a 'FILTER' sidebar with a 'Show counts' toggle and a 'By sponsor' dropdown menu listing various users.

Feedback Fields:

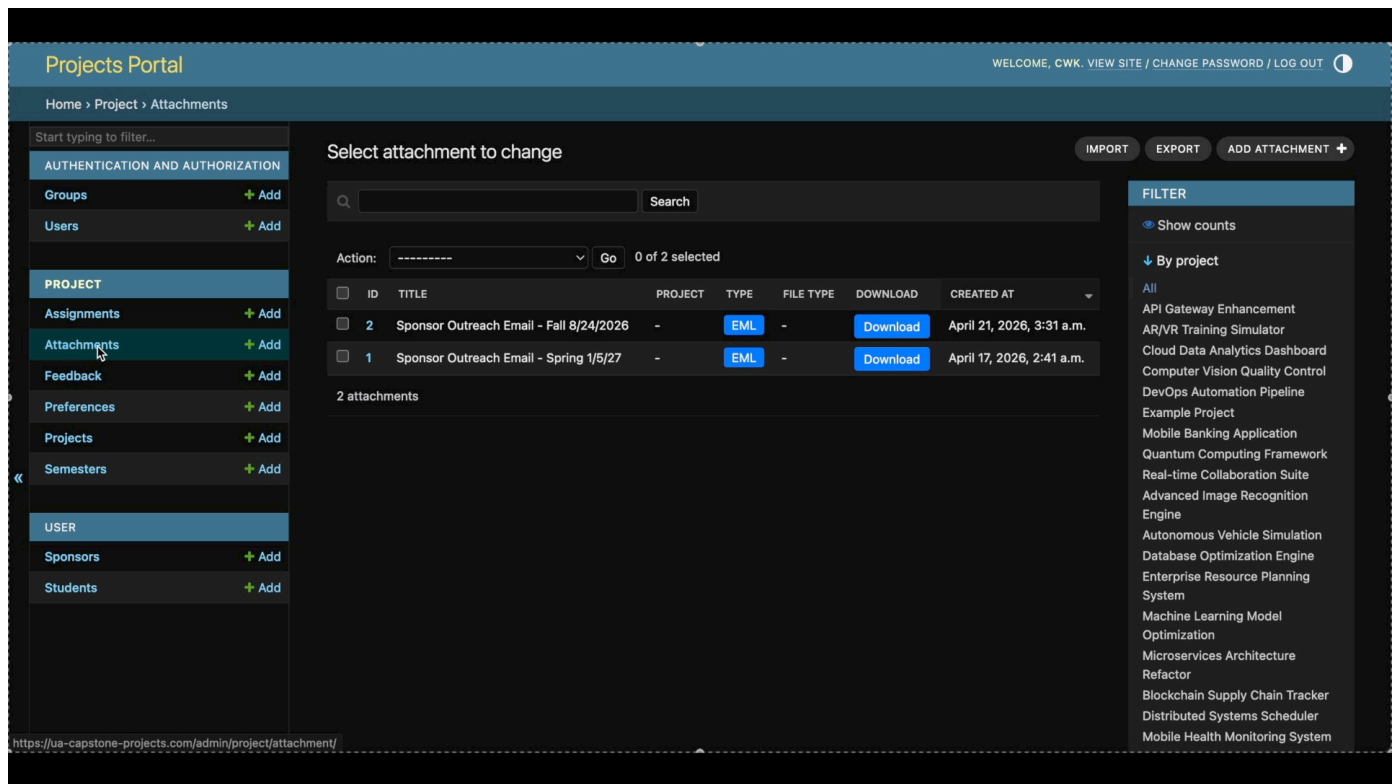
Field	Description
Project	The project this feedback relates to
Sponsor	The sponsor who gave the feedback
Content	The feedback message
Created	Date and time the feedback was submitted

The screenshot shows the 'Projects Portal' interface. At the top, there's a header with 'Projects Portal' on the left and 'WELCOME, CWK. VIEW SITE / CHANGE PASSWORD / LOG OUT' on the right. Below the header is a breadcrumb trail: 'Home > Project > Feedback'. The main content area is titled 'Select feedback to change'. It features a search bar, an 'Action:' dropdown menu, and a 'Go' button. Below this is a table with columns for 'ID', 'SPONSOR', and 'PROJECT'. The table shows one feedback item with ID 1, sponsored by 'Here My Dear', and related to the project 'A Funky Space Reincarnation'. To the right of the table is a 'FILTER' sidebar with a 'Show counts' option and a 'By sponsor' filter. The sidebar lists various sponsors including Jennifer Davis, Sarah Davis, John Doe, John Doe2, John Doe3, John Doe4, Robert Garcia, Jessica Hernandez, David Johnson, cole kelley, Jane Lopez, Sarah Lopez, Jennifer Martinez, Cole Munn, Jennifer Rodriguez, John Rodriguez, Michael Rodriguez, and Emily Williams. The left sidebar contains a navigation menu with sections for 'AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION' (Groups, Users), 'PROJECT' (Assignments, Attachments, Feedback, Preferences, Projects, Semesters), and 'USER' (Sponsors, Students).

Managing Attachments

To view and manage all file uploads:

1. Click on **Attachments** under the PROJECT section.
2. View all uploaded files and links.



Attachment Fields:

Field	Description
Project	The project this attachment belongs to
File	The uploaded file (click to download)
Link	An external URL
Title	A title for the attachment
Content	Email export content (for EML/HTML exports)

Downloading Attachments:

- Click on the file name to download
- Click on EML attachments to open in your default email client

Sending Bulk Emails to Sponsors

To send emails to multiple sponsors at once:

1. Click on **Sponsors** under the USER section.
2. Select the sponsors you want to email using the checkboxes.

3. From the "Action" dropdown menu, select an action:

Action	Description
Send Sponsor Outreach Email	Sends a recruitment email to selected sponsors via SMTP
Export Sponsor Outreach as EML	Creates downloadable EML files for each sponsor
Send Project Presentation Email	Sends presentation invitations for each project
Export Project Presentation as EML	Creates downloadable EML files for presentations

4. Click the **Go** button to execute the action.

5. Fill in the email form details.

6. Click **Send** to send the emails, or download the attachments.

Projects Portal

WELCOME, CWK. VIEW SITE / CHANGE PASSWORD / LOG OUT

Home > User > Sponsors

Start typing to filter...

AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION

Groups + Add

Users + Add

PROJECT

Assignments + Add

Attachments + Add

Feedback + Add

Preferences + Add

Projects + Add

Semesters + Add

USER

Sponsors + Add

Students + Add

Select sponsor to change

IMPORTEXPORTADD SPONSOR +

Q

Search

Action: Export Sponsor Outreach as EML 1 of 21 selected

☐	NAME	EMAIL	PROJECTS	ORGANIZATION
☐	c c	a564021@hotmail.com	0	c
☐	Jennifer Davis	jennifer.davis187@example.com	0	NextGen Inc
☐	Sarah Davis	sarah.davis322@example.com	0	Enterprise Plus
☒	Here My Dear	whyareallhippiesderelict@gmail.com	2	Here It Is
☐	John Doe	johndoe@crimson.ua.edu	0	University of Alabama
☐	John Doe2	shkorodi@crimson.ua.edu	0	University of Alabama
☐	John Doe3	sammy.k5890@gmail.com	0	University of Alabama
☐	John Doe4	gagora1463@dwseal.com	0	University of Alabama
☐	Robert Garcia	robert.garcia345@example.com	2	Innovation Labs
☐	Jessica Hernandez	jessica.hernandez968@example.com	2	Enterprise Plus
☐	David Johnson	david.johnson417@example.com	1	Tech Corp
☐	cole kelly	colewalkerleley@gmail.com	2	Stupid
☐	Jane Lopez	jane.lopez590@example.com	2	Advanced Tech
☐	Sarah Lopez	sarah.lopez663@example.com	3	Global Industries

FILTER

Show counts

By organization

All

Advanced Tech

c

Enterprise Plus

Example

Example Organization

Global Industries

Here It Is

Innovation Labs

NextGen Inc

Stupid

Tech Corp

University of Alabama

Projects Portal

WELCOME, CWK. VIEW SITE / CHANGE PASSWORD / LOG OUT

Home > User > Sponsors

Start typing to filter...

AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION

Groups + Add

Users + Add

PROJECT

Assignments + Add

Attachments + Add

Feedback + Add

Preferences + Add

Projects + Add

Semesters + Add

USER

Sponsors + Add

Students + Add

Select sponsor to change

IMPORTEXPORTADD SPONSOR +

Go0 of 21 selected

Action: ✓ -----

Delete selected sponsors

Export Sponsor Outreach as EML

Send Sponsor Outreach Email

Export Project Presentation as EML

Send Project Presentation Email

		PROJECTS	ORGANIZATION
☐	NA	0	c
☐	c c	0	NextGen Inc
☐	Je	0	Enterprise Plus
☐	Sarah Davis	0	Enterprise Plus
☐	Here My Dear	2	Here It Is
☐	John Doe	0	University of Alabama
☐	John Doe2	0	University of Alabama
☐	John Doe3	0	University of Alabama
☐	John Doe4	0	University of Alabama
☐	Robert Garcia	2	Innovation Labs
☐	Jessica Hernandez	2	Enterprise Plus
☐	David Johnson	1	Tech Corp
☐	cole kelly	2	Stupid
☐	Jane Lopez	2	Advanced Tech
☐	Sarah Lopez	3	Global Industries

Filter

Show counts

By organization

All

Advanced Tech

c

Enterprise Plus

Example

Example Organization

Global Industries

Here It Is

Innovation Labs

NextGen Inc

Stupid

Tech Corp

University of Alabama

Home > Export Sponsor Outreach as EML

Export Sponsor Outreach as EML

Export Sponsor Outreach as EML

1 sponsor(s) selected

Semester: Fall

Collection Date: 2026

Show PreviewCreate AttachmentCancel

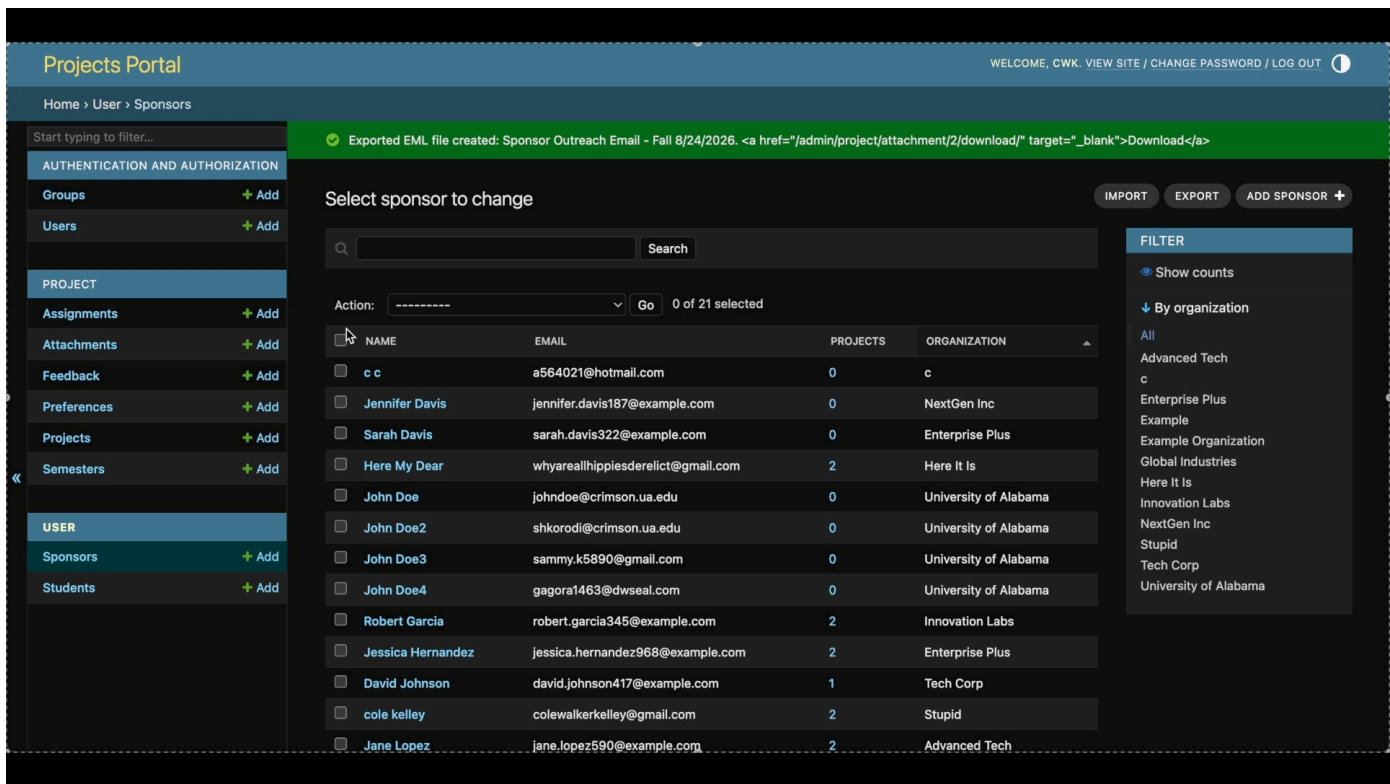
Email Preview

Hello,

I am reaching out to you and your organization regarding an opportunity to collaborate with the UA CS Capstone course this fall. This culminating experience enables students to showcase their knowledge and skills by developing real-world applications for external clients. Students work in groups of 4-6 for 15 weeks within an Agile project structure.

We are collecting projects for presentation for 2026. If you have any appropriate efforts, we would be very interested in working with you. Please complete the information form linked below. We present available projects the first week of each semester (2nd week of January and 3rd week of August). Students indicate their interest in available projects via a bid process.

We are interested in projects every semester. I am available to discuss possible projects and answer any questions. Feel free to email me or we can schedule a zoom meeting.



6. Email System

This section explains the email functionality built into the Capstone Design Manager.

Email Templates

The system includes predefined email templates:

Sponsor Outreach Email: This email is sent to recruit new sponsors or remind existing sponsors to submit projects. It includes instructions on how to submit a project and relevant deadlines.

Project Presentation Email: This email is sent to inform sponsors about their presentation time slot for the semester. It includes the date, time, and location (or virtual meeting link) for the presentation.

How to Send Emails Through the Admin Panel

To send emails from the admin panel:

1. Navigate to the admin panel at `/admin/`.

2. Go to the Sponsors list.
3. Select the sponsors you want to send emails to.
4. Choose an email action from the dropdown.
5. Click the **Go** button.
6. Fill in the required fields in the email form.
7. Click **Send** to send immediately.

How to Use EML Files

If SMTP sending is not available or you prefer to send emails manually, you can export emails as EML files:

1. Select sponsors in the admin panel.
2. Choose either "Export Sponsor Outreach as EML" or "Export Project Presentation as EML".
3. Click **Go**.
4. The system creates attachment records with EML files.
5. Go to **Attachments** in the admin panel.
6. Click on each EML file to download.
7. Double-click the downloaded EML file to open it in your default email client (Outlook, Apple Mail, etc.).
8. The email will open as a new unsent message with the recipient pre-filled.
9. Click **Send** from your email client.

AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION

Groups + Add

Users + Add

PROJECT

Assignments + Add

Attachments + Add

Feedback Add

Preferences + Add

Projects + Add

Semesters + Add

USER

Sponsors [+ Add](#)

Students + Add

Select attachment to change

Action: ----- Go 0 of 2 selected

	ID	TITLE	PROJECT	TYPE	FILE TYPE	DOWNLOADED	FILE NAME	FILE SIZE	DATE
☐	2	Sponsor Outreach Email - Fall 8/24/2026	-	EML	-	Download	8.png	105 KB - 20 hours ago	
☐	1	Sponsor Outreach Email - Spring 1/5/27	-	EML	-	Download			April 17, 2026, 2:41 a.m.

2 attachments

 **OneDrive_1_4-20-2026.zip**
236 KB • 56 minutes ago

 **user-guide.md**
35.4 KB · 1 hour ago

 data_set.png
62.1 KB • 20 hours ago

 **backpropagation_in_neural_network_8.png**
105 KB · 20 hours ago

load April 17, 2026, 2:41 a.m.

PORT ADD ATTACHMENT +

2
w counts

project

teaway Enhancement

Real-time Data Analytics Dashboard

Computer Vision Quality Control

People Project

File Banking A

Real-time Collaboration Suite

Guided Image Recognition

Autonomous Vehicle Simulation

base Optimization Engine

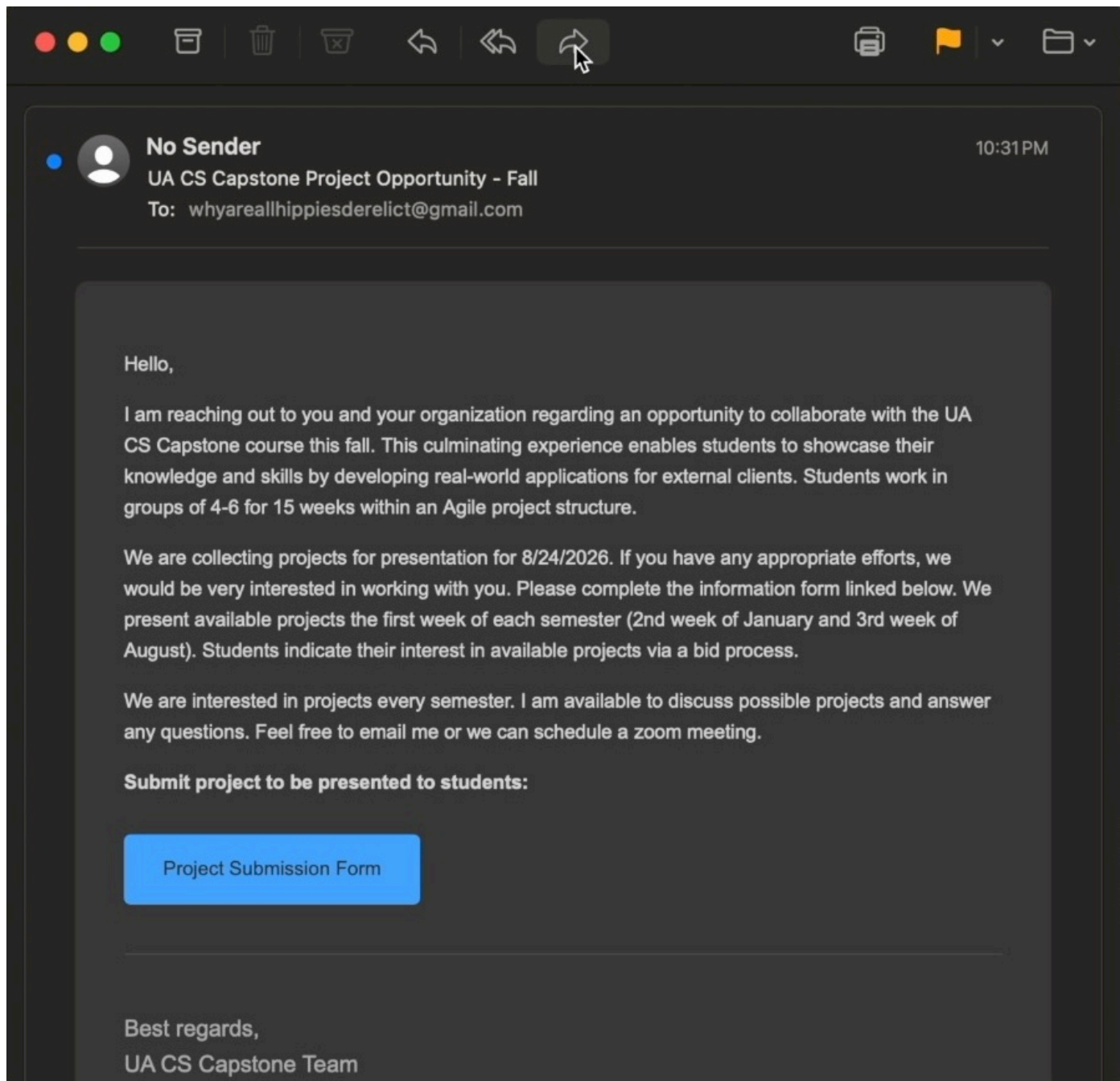
em

Online Learning Model Optimization

oservice:

Blockchain Supply Chain Tra

Distributed Systems Scheduler



7. Troubleshooting

This section provides solutions to common problems you may encounter.

Student Troubleshooting

Issue	Possible Cause	Solution
	Not using	Students must use their

Cannot log in	@crimson.ua.edu email	@crimson.ua.edu email address
Account exists but features not working	Student record not in database	Contact your instructor to be added to the system
Cannot rank projects	Past the preference deadline	Contact your instructor if you need an extension
Cannot view assignment	Assignments not yet created	Wait until after the assignment date, or contact the administrator
Profile information wrong	Incorrect data in database	Contact your instructor to correct your information

Sponsor Troubleshooting

Issue	Possible Cause	Solution
Cannot log in	Account not recognized	Try using Google sign-in, or create a new account
Form says email already exists	Duplicate account	Try logging in instead, or use a different login method
Cannot submit project	Required fields empty	Fill in all required fields (Project Name and Description)
File upload fails	File too large or wrong type	Check that file is under 25 MB and is PDF, DOCX, PPTX, PNG, JPG, or ZIP
Cannot see students assigned	Assignments not yet created	Wait until after the assignment date

Admin Troubleshooting

Issue	Possible Cause	Solution
Cannot	Not a	

access /admin/	superuser	Create a superuser account using <code>python manage.py createsuperuser</code>
Email sending fails	SMTP not configured	Check email settings in .env file
File upload fails	MinIO not running	Check that MinIO container is running
Students cannot log in	No student records	Add students to the database through the admin panel

Getting Help

If you continue to experience issues:

1. Check this troubleshooting section for a solution.
2. Contact your system administrator for technical support.
3. For development issues, consult the README.md file in the repository.

Additional Information

Email Communication

All email communication is sent from the system to notify users:

- **Sponsor Outreach:** Sent at the beginning of each semester to recruit projects
- **Project Presentation:** Sent to inform sponsors of their presentation time slot
- **Verification:** Sent when users need to verify their email address

Data Storage

The application stores data in several places:

- **User Accounts:** Stored in the authentication system (Auth0)
- **Student/Sponsor Records:** Stored in PostgreSQL database
- **Project Information:** Stored in PostgreSQL database

- **Uploaded Files:** Stored in Google Cloud Storage

Related Documentation

For more information, see these documents:

- **README.md** (root directory) - General project overview and setup instructions
- **backend/README.md** - Backend development documentation
- **frontend/README.md** - Frontend development documentation
- **backend/emails/README.md** - Email system details

Quick Reference

Application URLs

Service	URL	Description
Main Application	https://ua-capstone-projects.com/	The production web application
Admin Panel	https://ua-capstone-projects.com/admin/	Django admin interface
REST API	https://ua-capstone-projects.com/api/v1/	API endpoints
Local Development	http://localhost:5173	Local frontend (development)
Local Admin	http://localhost:8000/admin	Local admin (development)
Email Testing	http://localhost:8025	View sent emails (development)

Common Task Locations

Task	User Role	Location in Application
------	-----------	-------------------------

Create account	All	Landing page > Sign Up
Log in	All	Landing page > Log In
Submit a project	Sponsor	Sidebar > Submit Project
View my projects	Sponsor	Sidebar > Project Dashboard
View all projects	Student	Sidebar > Project Gallery
Rank project preferences	Student	Submit/Edit Rankings
View project assignment	Student	Dashboard (after assignment)
View my projects	Sponsor	Project Dashboard
Manage all students	Admin	/admin/ > USER > Students
Manage all sponsors	Admin	/admin/ > USER > Sponsors
Manage all projects	Admin	/admin/ > PROJECT > Projects
Send sponsor emails	Admin	/admin/ > Select Sponsors > Choose Action

Google Cloud Deployment (Current Production)

This project is currently hosted on Google Cloud Platform. The deployment uses the following Google Cloud services:

- **Backend:** Hosted on Google Cloud Run
- **Database:** PostgreSQL on Google Cloud SQL
- **File Storage:** Google Cloud Storage for attachments
- **Frontend:** Firebase Hosting

Google Cloud Credits:

This project uses educational credits provided by Google Cloud for students. The \$50 in credits covers the hosting costs for this semester.

For technical documentation for developers, please refer to the README.md file in the root directory and the backend/README.md file in the backend directory.

© 2026 Capstone Design Manager · Inspired by The University of Alabama

